

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Vehicle breakdown

VEHICLE TRAVEL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move out of traffic if you safely can, switch on hazard lights and call roadside assistance or emergency services for immediate danger. Give your road, direction and nearest marker. On a high-speed road, follow local road-authority advice about whether to stay belted inside or exit to a protected area.

Do now.

- ☐ **Protect from traffic**
01 Do not stand in travel lanes or between vehicles. Avoid repairs beside moving traffic.
- ☐ **Give a precise location**
02 Share the road name, direction, marker and number of people.
- ☐ **Assess immediate danger**
03 If fire, smoke or a collision threat makes the vehicle unsafe, move to a safe location away from traffic when possible.
- ☐ **Wait safely**
04 Keep children and pets protected and conserve phone power. In remote areas do not wander without a known safe destination.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Record your exact location, stay visible without standing in traffic and conserve your phone. Do not begin walking along a dangerous road or into remote terrain without a known reachable refuge. In heat or cold, watch occupants closely and reassess whether the vehicle remains safe.

Watch for.

Exit choices depend on the road and surroundings; do not apply one universal rule to every breakdown.

People & practical needs.

Count occupants, monitor temperature and keep children away from traffic. Preserve medicines, water and a light within reach

Next decision.

Carry water, weather protection, a charged phone and a vehicle kit. Check tires, fuel or charge before travel.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Vehicle breakdown · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/vehicle-breakdown/>